OECS HR & Payroll



User Guide v5 · The payroll manager’s workflow

Prepare → Review → Approve → Report

A practical guide to employee folders, pay rates and hours, flexible payroll periods, departmental reports and the AI Payroll Officer.

Caribbean operations, human control

Examples use fictional Smiley’s Tinting Services staff in Saint Lucia. Never use samples as live employee accounts. AI is an advisory reviewer: it cannot change pay, approve payroll or transfer money.

1. Prepare the people and records

Sign in and confirm access

Use email/password, configured Google sign-in or an administrator-assigned PIN with your email. Keep your PIN private. Payroll managers can manage operational payroll and edit employee folders; account creation and deletion remain administrator-controlled.

Set up each employee folder

Open Employees → Live employees. Administrators can add employees without an email; this creates an employment record, not a login account. Managers edit existing folders. Complete Personal, Employment, Payroll and Emergency details; save, reopen and check the values.

Pick or enter HR details

Use searchable dropdowns for department, job title, reporting manager, location, city, nationality and schedule. You can enter your own values. Confirm department membership before choosing a payroll group.

Keep HR files private

In Documents, upload contracts, certifications or other HR files; choose an expiry date and whether the employee may see the file. HR manages files. Staff see only their own explicitly shared files. Downloads use temporary links. Employee files do not belong in the public Training Hub.

Before payroll

Review start/end dates, employment status, statutory IDs, bank details, deductions and additions. Expiry tracking helps identify renewals but does not certify legal compliance. Review actual attendance separately; simulated clock punches never feed live payroll.

2. Set the rate and working hours

Pay basis is separate from payroll period

In the employee's Payroll tab choose Monthly, Semi-monthly, Weekly, Daily or Hourly and enter the matching rate. Payroll saves a monthly-equivalent salary. The Run Payroll period then determines the share of that saved salary paid.

Weekly hours—not a fixed 9-to-5

Enter Standard daily hours and Hours per work week. Monthly hours = weekly hours × 52 ÷ 12. For example, 36 hours/week gives 156 hours/month; 40 hours/week gives approximately 173.33 hours/month.

Hourly example

At XCD 10/hour and 36 hours/week, monthly-equivalent pay is XCD 1,560. A weekly run pays approximately XCD 360 before deductions. These are contractual estimates, not a count of actual clocked hours.

Daily example

At XCD 80/day, 36 hours/week and 6 hours/day, the schedule implies 6 days/week: 80 × 6 × 52 ÷ 12 = XCD 2,080/month. If weekly hours are blank, conversion assumes five days/week using the daily hours.

Other bases and important limits

Monthly rate is unchanged; semi-monthly rate × 2; weekly rate × 52 ÷ 12. Save the folder to update the salary used by payroll. Run Payroll does not automatically pay actual attendance hours or calculate overtime. Its minimum-wage check uses an estimated daily-hours calculation; review unusual schedules manually.

3. Choose who and when to pay

Open Run Payroll

Choose Live employees, the jurisdiction and one, two or any number of departments. Sample company is a separate fictional preview and never saves live payroll.

Monthly / Semi-monthly

Monthly covers a complete calendar month. Semi-monthly covers the 1st–15th or the 16th–month end and pays half the monthly salary.

Weekly

Choose Week starting. The end date is six days later. Salary is prorated by 12 ÷ 52 of the saved monthly equivalent.

Custom dates / final pay

Choose From and To, then tick only the employees to pay. Add a reason such as “Final pay — dismissal”. Custom pay counts Monday–Friday at monthly salary × 12 ÷ 260 per working day. XCD 2,600/month over eight weekdays gives XCD 960 basic pay.

Deductions and additions

The NIC ceiling and PAYE thresholds are scaled by the period factor. Monthly recurring creditor deductions are prorated. One-off additions assigned to the start month are included in full: check that a bonus is not reused in another run. Holidays are not excluded from custom weekday counting. Severance, notice pay, accrued leave and local statutory treatment need manual professional review.

4. Review with the AI Payroll Officer

Review & Sync → Audit

Compare every employee’s basic pay, additions, gross, NIC, PAYE, creditor deductions and net. Continue to Audit. The existing warning checks the configured minimum wage, not every payroll or legal obligation.

Request the AI review

Select Review this payroll. The officer receives anonymous Employee N / Department N references, draft amounts and missing-ID/minimum-wage flags—not names, email, NIC/TAN values, bank details or private documents. It returns a draft summary, issues to check and next steps.

Act on exceptions

Match Employee N to the same row position in Employee Payroll Preview. Verify zero pay, deductions, missing statutory identifiers and any discrepancy. Edit employee details, additions or deductions in the appropriate page; return and review the refreshed draft. Changing period, departments or draft amounts discards the old AI review.

Human control remains essential

The officer has no access to saved run history, attendance, private HR documents or QuickBooks records. It cannot verify current laws, approve, save, edit figures or pay staff. Verify recommendations; an AI review is not a compliance certificate.

If AI is unavailable

No payroll is changed. Read the displayed error, review manually, and request a new review later if needed. No automatic replay of a failed AI request is performed. This is a contextual payroll reviewer, not an ongoing chat or autonomous payroll operator.

5. Approve, check reports and arrange payment

Continue to Approve

Review the summary, department count, employee count, gross pay, employee/employer NIC, PAYE and total net pay. Only a manager or administrator can Approve & Save Payroll. AI does not perform this action.

Read the saved result

A successful live approval saves the run and employee payslips together. The server rejects overlapping paid dates per employee; an overlap is checked at approval, not by AI. If approval fails, read the message and correct the draft—do not assume staff were paid.

Departmental and consolidated reports

Open Reports or Payroll History and select the saved period. Compare Departmental with Consolidated totals; export PDF or CSV and retain the payroll record. Saved names and departments reflect the approved run rather than later folder changes.

Payslips and actual payment

Use saved employee payslips for delivery where supported. Sample payslips do not send mail. A saved payroll run is not a bank transfer: arrange wage payment separately and verify receipt. Check account-free employee delivery options manually.

QuickBooks handoff

Payroll Settings pairs earnings, NIC/PAYE liabilities, deductions, assets and bank accounts with QuickBooks accounts. Review Auto-map proposals; placeholders are not live accounts. QuickBooks Sync remains a simulation until production credentials and OAuth are configured. Verify production posting separately; no live journal or payment is promised.

6. Training, operations and proven patterns

Current resources

Both Training Hubs include the latest v5 guide and v4 brochure. Download or share them from https://caribbean-payroll-with-quickbooks.lovable.app/training-public. Published links show the new revision only after the app is republished. Earlier uploaded documents are retained. Managers may upload additional public training material; never upload confidential employee data.

Hire-to-paid operations

Applicant Tracking supports recruitment; Compliance tracks licenses and expiry; rosters, sites, geofencing, guard tours, incident reports and invoicing support field operations. Verify attendance, alerts, voice processing and billing with real permissions before relying on automation. Device and simulated clocks remain separate; reset simulation for training only.

Examples from existing platforms

The workflow follows familiar patterns: Gusto’s Gus provides payroll/HR guidance with verification cautions; Rippling describes AI exception detection and approval before action; ADP describes anomaly detection and guided payroll resolution. These are examples, not connections or endorsements. Their capabilities are not automatically present in this app.

Official references · checked 20 October 2026

Gusto: Use Gus, Gusto’s AI assistant
Rippling: AI for HR, payroll and IT
ADP Workforce Now: Payroll

Go-live checklist

Confirm employees and rates; validate local taxes and final-pay entitlements; review actual worked time; request and check AI advice; approve a real run; read saved reports/payslips; confirm wage payment and delivery separately. Current configured jurisdictions are Saint Lucia, Antigua and Barbuda, Saint Kitts and Nevis, Dominica and Grenada. Other islands require added, validated configurations—not automatic legal coverage.